



A SPIRITED STORY OF POWER AND GRACE

Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli may have **said their goodbyes to T20I cricket**, but their legacies will endure forever.

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The fans of the Indian cricket team know all about pantomime. From the disappointment of a semifinal defeat in the 2022 T20 World Cup and the harrowing pain of losing the final of the 50-over World Cup at home last year to now rising back up again triumphantly with a second T20 World Cup title — it was a fairytale turnaround reminiscent of Cinderella.

Indian cricket's rollercoaster journey has thus been a parable of modern cricket. The team's T20 World Cup final victory at the Kensington Oval in Bridgetown, Barbados, with thousands of fans and a garnish of subsequent emotions and celebrations, made an ideal backdrop for two of the sport's greatest practitioners and trend-setters — Rohit Sharma and Virat Kohli — to bring the curtains down on their respective T20I careers.

Rohit joins the ranks of eight West Indians — Samuel Badree, Dwayne Bravo, Johnson Charles, Chris Gayle, Denesh Ramdin, Andre Russell, Daren Sammy, and Marlon Samuels — who have won the men's T20 World Cup twice, while Kohli departs with the honour of being named Player of

the Match in the T20 World Cup final, a record 16th time in T20Is. He also secured the one white-ball trophy missing from his cabinet.

While Kohli embodied the smoke and magic nature of T20 cricket as it began Rohit encapsulated what the format became: fire and brimstone. Revisiting their time together merits the use of the word awesome. **Rohit exits the format as its highest scorer (4231 runs in 159 matches), with Kohli close behind (4188 runs in 125 matches) — a combined total of 8419 runs.**

Their retirement from T20I was not entirely unexpected. Both players had skipped the format after India's 2022 T20 World Cup semifinal defeat, returning only in January this year with a focus on this T20 World Cup.

Rohit's performance in this edition was a testament to his fresh all-out aggressive approach, regardless of